



## BEFORE

Sherman's march through Georgia had badly damaged Confederate morale. Union leaders now sought to reap the benefits.

## BRINGING THE WAR HOME

Earlier in the war, the **deep Southern states had escaped much of the fighting**, which was concentrated in border areas to the north and west. That **situation changed** dramatically with Sherman's invasion of Georgia and the evaporation of large-scale armed resistance after the fall of Atlanta. The question now was how best to **press home the advantage**.

## REVIVING THE ANACONDA PLAN



With General Sherman in Savannah, Federal strategists saw a chance at last to **implement fully the Anaconda Plan**, originally proposed by General Winfield Scott in 1861 ([see Organizing for the Fight](#)). The project involved enveloping and **finally suffocating the remaining Confederate command centers** in Virginia.

Initially, General Grant—fearing the hazardous state of South Carolina's roads in the winter—wanted to ship General William T. Sherman's victorious troops from Savannah to support his own forces in Virginia. Sherman, however, insisted that his men were up to the task of overcoming any difficulties confronting them. Given that it would have taken two months to arrange the shipping option, Grant let himself be persuaded.

Although Sherman was to encounter formidable obstacles in his path, the opposition forces were the least of his worries. General P. G. T. Beauregard, commanding Confederate troops in South Carolina, had only about 17,500 men scattered across the state to combat Sherman's 60,000 battle-hardened veterans. In addition, morale in the Union ranks was extremely high. Most of the men were champing at the bit at the prospect of carrying the war to the state where the fighting had started. In the minds of many